

Visions of Fifth Fade for Indians

Special to The News

WICHITA—The Indianapolis Indians lost their self-appointed commission as spoilers in the American Association and also their hopes for fifth place here last night.

The Indians, who beat the Wichita Braves five straight times in Indianapolis last week to revive the pennant race, helped rebury it here by dropping 3-1 and 7-5 decisions to the league leaders.

Manager Andy Cohen's crew still has three games left with Wichita, but the Braves have a 2½-game lead over Denver with only three games to play.

Thus, the only chance the Indians have for spoiling now is mathematical. And that's the same kind of shot they have at fifth place. They trail Omaha by two games in the loss column with three games to play.

OLD INDIAN STORY UNFOLDS

Last night was an old story for the Indians. They just couldn't match their hitting and pitching. They set some kind of a record by getting at least one hit in each of the first 13 innings they batted, and were set down in order only twice all night.

Vince Garcia collected seven hits and Charley Williams had five, but Neil Chrisley, Jim Del-sing, and Ron Jackson—the towers of power—went 1-for-22. Jackson struck out five times in eight trips and hit the ball out of the infield only once.

Chrisley injured his foot in the first game, and saw only pinch-hitting duty in the nightcap. Cohen said he thought Neil would be back in the lineup tonight.

The Braves took the seven-inning opener as Carlton Wil-

ley won his 21st game in a duel with Jim McDonald.

Harry Hankebrink's 23d homer with a man on in the third was the payoff blow, but McDonald deserved a better fate. He rationed out only six hits, and all three Wichita runs were the direct result of mental and mechanical errors.

Hanebrink's homer was set up when Garcia was slow covering second on a double play ball, and the third Wichita run came after Jackson dropped a perfect throw from McDonald.

Jim Landis had his best batting day since being sent down by the White Sox in the nightcap as he hit two home runs.

HOMER WINS 2D GAME, TOO

The Indians built up a 5-2 lead, but some ineffective pitching by Starter Roy Tinney and some ineffective defensive work in left field helped the Braves tie the score in the seventh. Earl Hersh's 25th homer with two out in the 12th broke up the game.

Joey Jay will work for Wichita tonight, while Cohen has tentatively tabbed Tony Ponce for starting honors.

A combination of a iWchita victory and a Denver split against St. Paul will give the Braves the pennant.

